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# Success: How Citizen Control of Politics Is Achieved

This chapter offers more specific answers to the puzzle outlined in Chapter 1. It also explains what the trade-offs are in offering more or less specific answers and what kind of answers are more or less warranted by the evidence. I bring the reader on a journey through a logical comparison of the characteristics of PB cases and present findings to inform the implementation of democratic reform. I consider again those touted necessary conditions for empowered participation such as participatory leadership and civil society demand for involvement, and outline the specific circumstances under which they can be (ir)relevant to explanations of empowered participation.

I revisit Wampler's analysis, confirming the finding that no conditions ought to be considered singularly necessary, but some are necessary in specific contexts – the evidence suggests that in a Brazilian context contentious politics must be combined with either rules enabling participation *or* a financial basis for implementation of projects to produce democratic deepening. Moreover, I find democratic deepening in challenging financial circumstances is certainly possible, but all other factors need to be pointing in the right direction – a finding that suggests that in recovering or developing economic circumstances, PB requires positive political, institutional and civil society conditions for democratic deepening.

I then focus on the wider lessons across cases, and explain that meaningful involvement of citizens in collective governance often requires a combination of will and capacity to implement programmes from political *and* administrative leaders. I explain why political commitment to participatory politics is only a sufficient condition for good outcomes in combination with bureaucratic capacities *or* financial freedoms. I revisit the question of how civil society activity may explain



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democratic deepening for which the evidence is mixed. Again, there is evidence across all cases that financial constraints may concentrate the mind of actors – politicians, bureaucrats and autonomous civil society activists can work together for PB overcoming resource burdens. Nevertheless, I also find evidence that more top-down approaches to developing civil society capacities developed appreciably democratic results. I can pinpoint the extent of contradictory evidence that has been presented by researchers to highlight priorities for future research. Designers and adopters of PB can note substitutable combinations of conditions that have been consistently successful in achieving empowered participation.

## Elimination using Boolean algorithmic analysis: a little helpful basics

The analysis of sufficiency relies on principles of logical elimination. Savolainen has argued that the value of Mill's methods of comparison is 'in their capacity to eliminate a limited set of alternative causal statements' (1994: 1218; see also Peters, 2013; Ryan, 2018). This element of elimination is sorely overlooked in the social sciences – unfortunately the quest for 'novel' findings often creates an incentive to add extra explanations to the ones we have. Elimination can be equally useful and novel, by reducing costs of preoccupations with less relevant features of explanations. This element of comparative research is undervalued, but I think systematic case-based comparison can have an even more subtle crucial advantage that is often overlooked. That is, it can reduce over-determination *and* under-determination in an apposite manner (Ryan, 2018). A set-theoretic approach avoids seeing hypotheses as being in strict competition but as alternative cloudy solutions that require distillation. I will again take the reader through the process using examples to explain how it works, but it is useful to briefly set out some basic principles here.

In simple terms, when two cases produce the same outcome, but differ only in one explanatory variable, the variable that distinguishes the two cases can be considered irrelevant and be removed (Caramani, 2009: 72). For example, if:

$A \star \sim B \star C \rightarrow Y$ (solution 1)

and

$A \star \sim B \star \sim C \rightarrow Y$ (solution 2)



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We can deem C redundant. The outcome Y occurs when it is both present (C) and absent (~C). Therefore:

$A \star \sim B \rightarrow Y$ (minimal solution)

We could say that the conjunction of the presence of A and the absence of B is sufficient for Y ($A \star \sim B$ represents the intersection of the set A and the set not B). A is an INUS condition, as is ~B.

Applications of Boolean logic to causal analysis can be used to discard irrelevant conditions while simultaneously identifying multiple parsimonious yet robust descriptions of causal relations over more than a handful of cases. This is done by testing alternative combinations of conditions for relationships of necessity and sufficiency (supersets and subsets) using Boolean logical operations such as logical 'AND' (the intersection of sets) and logical 'OR' (the union of sets). It also allows us to use simple Boolean negation operations – logical 'NOT' (negation of sets) – to show whether and when the absence of a condition contributes to outcomes.

We can therefore test the causal claims and develop the intuitions of the researchers who have advanced the field up to now using their in-depth casework. These issues of apposite determination have been far from ignored by the methodologists of social science who have come up with many ingenious ways of handling these problems. However, the QCA I disclose provides a good exemplar for an approach that incorporates these concerns in a coherent and holistic manner.

There is no conceptual difference in the way Boolean minimization is applied to fuzzy sets (Ragin, 2009: 88). Following Zadeh (1965) and Ragin (2009: 94–103), fuzzy sets directly correspond to the crisp dichotomies in the example. In crisp dichotomies where A is present (set membership = 1), the negation of A is logically absent (set membership in ~A = 0). That is ~A = 1 – A. This formula holds for fuzzy sets. A case holds degrees of membership of the negation of any set to the degree that it is not a member of the original set. For example, if a case has a membership value of 0.33 in the set of autonomous civil society demand for participatory politics (csd), its membership value in the set representing the absence of this civil society demand (~csd) is [1 – 0.33] = 0.67.

Similarly, when two sets intersect, a case is a member of that intersection if it is an element of each one of the two sets that intersect. That is, a case is present in a conjunction $A \star B$ if its set membership value for set A = 1 and value for set B = 1. If its membership in either A or B is 0, that is, less than 1, it is not a member of $A \star B$ (where either A = 0, or B = 0, then $A \star B = 0$). The value a case's membership takes in a conjunction



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of two or more sets is the minimum value that it takes in each of the individual sets that make up the conjunction. That is, A*B = min(A,B). This formula holds for fuzzy sets. If a case's membership value in the set of participatory leadership (pl) is 0.83 and in the set of bureaucratic support (bsp) is 0.67, its membership in the conjunction of both conditions, participatory leadership AND bureaucratic support (PL*BSP) is 0.67 (the minimum of the two values). If we wanted to know the case's value in the conjunction of the absence of participatory leadership AND the presence of bureaucratic support (~pl*BSP), we would need to calculate the negation of the former set and the minimum value of both, that is, min[(1–0.83),0.67] = 0.17.

We can use these mathematical principles to calculate each case's membership in a combination of conditions, and then, as we did for necessity, test whether that combination holds to the superset relation of sufficiency across cases. The measures of consistency and coverage from these tests can inform us which kinds of explanations fit the data. For those combinations that do, we can then apply Boolean elimination algorithms to remove redundant determinants from explanations.

## The truth table

In Table 7.1 I present a truth table derived from the fuzzy data matrix first presented in Chapter 5. The truth table is an impressive analytical device. Each row corresponds to a logical combination of presence or absence of conditions. Although our cases have fuzzy membership in many rows, they are logically 'more in' and have greater than 0.5 set membership in only one row. That is the row to which they are ascribed in the truth table. Cases may differ to the extent they have membership in that row (making them stronger or weaker examples of the combination of conditions), but this is the row that best describes the case. Each one of the 16 rows can be thought of as an ideal type of PB (see Schneider and Wagemann, 2012: 98).[1]

The truth table is a really useful device for cumulation, both when working alone and in collaboration with other researchers in any field. It is useful in the first instance to look at it without reference

[1] A truth table differs from a data matrix in that each row in a truth table corresponds to a logical case rather than a data record. In a crisp-set QCA, each case can only be a member of one logical conjunction of all the conditions under observation because a condition cannot be observed to be both present and absent at the same time – this would be a logical contradiction. Each row in a truth table represents one of these possible combinations of presence or absence of each of the observed explanatory conditions in an analysis. In the analysis presented here we have



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to the outcome, and to assess how empirical cases fall in relation to key explanatory factors. The truth table is not accidently named. It lays bare the consequences of assumptions and coding in constructing comparative research. It can engineer a useful dialogue between cases in a population and the concepts we are trying to understand – in other words, between theory and evidence. The truth table can then show which empirical cases are logically identical (in terms of their properties) and which are not. That information can improve the formation of typologies and require researchers to think hard about how similar or different cases really are. Are these cases that share a truth table row really the same kinds of cases, or are they different?

I can immediately find reassurances that some cases that researchers themselves considered part of the same type coalesce here. For example, row 2 articulates the logical basis for Wampler's category of emasculated participatory democracy, and row 1 reflects McNulty's unsuccessful cases. But we also can see the sometimes surprising result that cases from far-flung parts of the world appear to have some logical equivalence when it comes to key conditions for participatory democracy. It challenges the common idea that cultural or country factors are key determinants of PB. It can, of course, also be a warning signal of some misinterpretation. The point is that the truth table organizes that information across a large number of cases so it can be transparently evaluated.

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16 possible logical combinations and 16 rows in the truth table. Schneider and Wagemann highlight that 'Each row denotes a *qualitatively different* combination of conditions, ie the difference in cases in different rows is a difference in kind rather than a difference in degree' (2012: 92; original emphasis). This systematic approach to revealing and classifying types is overlooked by most work in comparative social science. The corresponding important logical property of fuzzy sets is that each case can only have greater than a 0.5 membership value in one of these logical combinations of conditions representing a truth table row. Another way of saying this is that each case is a good example of only one of the ideal types represented by each truth table row. Fuzzy sets allow that each case can, and often will, have partial membership in each of our 16 possible logical combinations; 1 and 0 represent the extreme values of full membership and full non-membership in the set representing presence or absence of a condition. In the four-dimensional property space created by four conditions, each case can only be found closest to the vertex representing one of these ideal types. Empirical cases have partial membership in all kinds of logical cases, but they have strong membership only in one. This highlights that the cruciality of the conceptual definition of the crossover point in calibration cannot be undersold. In calibrating, the researcher makes an important decision as to whether a case is more in or more out of the set.



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**Table 7.1:** Truth table for 31 cases

| # | Participatory leadership | Autonomous civil society demand | Bureaucratic support | Financial basis to spend | Cases | Outcome: citizen control of PB |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | No[1] | No | No | No | Ayacucho, Loreto, Mauá, Toronto | No |
| 2 | No | No | No | Yes | Blumenau, Rio Claro | No |
| 3 | No | No | Yes | No | Buenos Aires | No |
| 4 | No | No | Yes | Yes | No cases | Unknown |
| 5 | No | Yes | No | No | Recife (i), São Paulo | No |
| 6 | No | Yes | No | Yes | No cases | Unknown |
| 7 | No | Yes | Yes | No | Cajamarca | Yes |
| 8 | No | Yes | Yes | Yes | No cases | Unknown |
| 9 | Yes | No | No | No | Berlin-Lichtenstein | No |
| 10 | Yes | No | No | Yes | Montevideo, Poitou-Charentes, Sevilla | Contradiction[2] |
| 11 | Yes | No | Yes | No | Camaragibe, Lambayeque, Morsang-sur-Orge | Contradiction |
| 12 | Yes | No | Yes | Yes | Betim, Gravataí, Ipatinga | Contradiction |
| 13 | Yes | Yes | No | No | Moquegua, Rome, Santo André | No |
| 14 | Yes | Yes | No | Yes | Belo Horizonte, Chicago, Córdoba, New York | Contradiction |
| 15 | Yes | Yes | Yes | No | Cusco, Recife (ii) | Yes |
| 16 | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes | Porto Alegre, João Monlevade | Yes |

[1] Yes = present, No = absent. Each row can be considered a logical case or a type of PB.
[2] Contradiction here signifies that the two or more empirical cases that are strong members of the row do not agree on the outcome. In some it is present and in others it is absent.



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The truth table invites us to consider affinities that we might have easily assumed away. It is a useful prompt for case researchers to think more ecumenically than perhaps they are comfortable with, and to consider their cases as similar to those looked at by other researchers with slightly different research strategies. For example, in row 14 we see that cases from three different regions all show evidence of political support for the project, autonomous civil society demand, and relatively good financial situations compared to other such governing units in their countries. Nevertheless, in each case there are reports that administrators or technical teams were often actively working against implementation of either PB programmes or projects. Although each case – New York, Chicago, Córdoba and Belo Horizonte – fits this type to a different degree, the description of the cases in the literature suggest they all fit this type quite well.

A second advantage of the truth table is it can tell us which logical types of PB (combinations of conditions) we have empirical examples of and which we do not. When we make general claims about necessity and sufficiency we implicitly engage in counterfactual analysis of these unobserved combinations. With the truth table we can engage in that analysis explicitly and transparently. Rows 4, 6 and 8 represent what are called 'logical remainders'.[2] The diversity of our cases is limited. Is this because such cases are unlikely to exist or because we are blind to them? One explanation is that these rows represent hypothetical cases where financial resources are high, but some impetus from a combination of key actors is absent. It may be that participatory programmes are less likely to present under those conditions. Perhaps because their variation from more ostensibly successful scenarios is not as obvious as that provided in rows 1 and 2, the type of case is more likely to escape the attention of social scientists where it does exist. We have no strong empirical evidence for outcomes in these circumstances. Truth tables that cumulate research can therefore be used to justify later case selection strategies.

[2] Researchers must be clear about the assumptions they make about counterfactuals. An awareness of limited diversity can allow the researcher to make good transparent decisions about what key variables should be tested for causal relationships across cases. QCA researchers cannot hide away the exponential increases in the number of logical possible combinations of conditions where a new one is added. The discipline of calibration ensures the researcher still cannot escape tough decisions and theoretical justification of what is fully relevant, partially relevant or completely irrelevant variation. Such decisions will, in turn, be dictated by the richness of data and the number of cases. The methodical approach poses challenges and takes the analytical brain in a reflective direction.



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Finally, we can consult the outcome condition in the right-hand column to begin to understand which combinations produce the outcome of interest. In some rows all cases agree on the outcome and it is clearer where the combination is associated with citizen control of PB decisions or its absence. In other rows, cases present a logical contradiction. The same conditions lead to different outcomes in the cases. We might want to look at those cases that disagree and see if we can resolve the contradiction if there is some miscoding, or we are missing a key explanatory condition. However, this dichotomous data represents something of a simplification. We have in hand more fine-grained fuzzy memberships. With fuzzy sets there is almost always some inconsistency in each row, and we have measures of fit that can inform us as to whether the outcome ascribed to the row is supported by the evidence from all cases. Using the truth table researchers can transparently investigate, contribute to and challenge the construction of a medium-N comparison.

## Investigating sufficient conditions

We can now use the algorithms developed for Boolean reduction to assess, based on the cumulated evidence presented, what combinations of conditions are sufficient to produce our outcome or negate it. Explaining logically the absence of the outcome is one of the most undervalued and underemphasized strengths of case-based research designs.

Recall in Chapter 6 that we introduced the QCA approach initially by looking at how it might model Wampler's most parsimonious conclusion. Before returning to the 31-case analysis, the example is again used to help understand how conceptualization can affect analysis of sufficient conditions, and when strong or even weaker claims of sufficiency of conditions are warranted. We observed the effect of different set calibrations, representing different interpretations of deepened democracy in Table 6.2 on the analysis of necessity. Minimized sufficient conditions for the outcome 'deepened democracy' are presented in Table 7.2. The comparison of different potential interpretations is again instructive for exposing some of the pitfalls in analysis. It is important to understand how accuracy of set-theoretic inferences can depend very much on how we conceptualize and measure the evidence, and is aided by an understanding of how conceptual and causal theories can be mathematically represented.

In Chapter 6 we showed that the 'C' calibration was the only one to confirm both mayoral support and support for contentious politics



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**Table 7.2:** Analysis of sufficient conditions for deepened democracy across 10 cases

| | Outcome tested | Sufficient conditions | Inclusion | PRI | Coverage |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Deepened democracy (A) | **Mayoral support** | 1 | 1 | 1 |
| 2 | Deepened democracy (B) | Mayoral support* **Citizen contentious politics** | 1 | 1 | 0.757 |
| 3 | Deepened democracy (C) | ∅ | – | – | – |

Note: Analysis performed using truthTable and minimize commands in the QCA package in R (Dusa, 2019). Measures of fit are reported for the conservative solutions only. Bold = core condition. The inclusion threshold was set at 0.8.

as necessary conditions for deepened democracy. I argued that the importance of this finding needed to be examined because highly restrictive standards for deep democracy often lead to a skewed distribution of set memberships. While a restrictive conceptualization of democracy logically lowers the requirements for necessity relationships, it logically increases the bar for sufficiency. If the set representing the outcome is restricted to a relatively small one in scope, it is ever more difficult to find a relevant smaller subset to fit that same set (a sufficient condition). In this example, we indeed find no evidence of sufficient conjunctions of the two conditions tested for relationships with deepened democracy 'C', as reported in row 3 of the table. Note, again, that the finding alone does not invalidate the argument about necessary conditions for deepened democracy or the conceptualization of deep democracy itself. What it identifies is the mathematical foundations that explain how restrictive conceptualizations of deep democracy (or any outcome) will lend themselves to long lists of necessary conditions and little evidence to explain what conjunctions of conditions might be sufficient for that outcome.

What of the alternative conceptualizations of deepened democracy? In Chapter 6 'deepened democracy A' was shown to necessitate mayoral support only. The finding rested on assumptions about what differences in quality signified key differences in kind that distinguish deep democracy from its negation. In Table 7.2 mayoral support alone is confirmed as sufficient under this interpretation (row 1). Citizen contentious politics is eliminated and assumed irrelevant. Again, the neat finding masks some thorny issues of assumption, which, if misunderstood, undermine that simple interpretation.



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**Table 7.3:** Truth table for outcome 'deepened democracy A'

| | Mayor support | Citizen contentious politics | Deep democracy | Number of cases | Inclusion | PRI | Cases |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 6 | 1 | 1 | Belo Horizonte, Ipatinga, Port Alegre (i), Porto Alegre (ii), Porto Alegre (iii), Recife |
| 2 | 1 | 0 | 1 | 2 | 1 | 1 | Santo André, São Paulo |
| 3 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 0.329 | 0 | Blumenau, Rio Claro |
| 4 | 0 | 1 | ? | 0 | – | – | – |

The example shows how conceptual (un)clarity can result in potentially erroneous elimination of causes. The assumption relies on an interpretation that the middle-of-the-road cases in Table 6.2 – Belo Horizonte, Port Alegre (early and latter versions), Recife, São Paulo, and Santo André – are slightly more in the set of deepened democracy, and equally slightly more in the set of mayoral support. The truth table is also an extremely useful tool for understanding conceptual and measurement choices in case research. The truth table for the outcome 'A', minimized in row 1 in Table 7.2, is now reproduced in Table 7.3. This truth table includes measures of fit. We can observe that two truth table rows are completely consistent with the subset relation (inclusion score of 1). These include row 1, where mayoral support combines with support for contentious politics, and row 2, where mayoral support combines with the absence of support for contentious politics. A logical minimization has taken place, to produce the output in row 1 of Table 7.2, where citizen support for contentious politics has been eliminated by being deemed an irrelevant factor. The outcome is observed regardless of variance in support for contentious politics, and that condition is eliminated from explanation. Thereby we arrive at the parsimonious solution



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**Table 7.4:** Truth table for outcome 'deepened democracy A' with alternative coding

| | Mayor support | Citizen contentious politics | Deep demo-cracy | Number of cases | Inclusion | PRI | Cases |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 4 | 1 | 1 | Belo Horizonte, Port Alegre (i), Porto Alegre (iii), Recife |
| 2 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 1 | 1 | Ipatinga, Porto Alegre (ii) |
| 3 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 4 | 0.338 | 0.02 | Blumenau, Rio Claro, Santo André, São Paulo |
| 4 | 1 | 0 | ? | 0 | – | – | – |

that mayoral support for contentious politics alone is sufficient for deepened democracy.

Nevertheless, the minimization here masks an important choice made (or in this case, mostly ignored) at the moment of calibration. As already explained, the difference between 0.49 and 0.51 in fuzzy set theory represents the important difference in quality that organizes a case as being more in a set or more in its negation. In Chapter 6 I rather uncritically ascribed many cases with medium mayoral support 0.51 membership in the relevant set (more in the set) to avoid ascribing them the indeterminate membership score of 0.5 in this example. What if I had ascribed some of them a score of 0.49? In Table 7.4, I observe the difference if the middle-of-the-road cases are ascribed a score of 0.49 (more out of) the set of mayoral support. This significant reinterpretation of cases' membership in an influencing condition pushes a number of cases into different truth table rows. Rather than eliminate citizen willingness to support contentious politics, the minimization will now eliminate mayoral support as a sufficient condition. The example shows the sensitivity of the theoretical distinction between what cases are more in or out of a set (either side of the 0.5 crossover point).



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It is important to understand that this sensitivity does not extend in the other direction within the fuzzy set. If I had recoded all those middling cases with a mayoral support set membership of 0.52, the substantive interpretation and the truthTable (Table 7.3) would not change (only to show some very minor inconsistency in the inclusion score).[3] This sensitivity of calibration around the crossover point is a strength and not a weakness, and shows that conceptual clarity is paramount in evaluating necessary and sufficient conditions. The elimination would have been entirely reasonable had the coding been justified using a theoretical standard. The example of deep democracy 'A' shows that fsQCA, when applied appropriately, is not a journey into indeterminacy but one that interacts with data to improve the ways in which the researcher can better understand their cases and relationships among them.

I have shown that conceptions 'A' and 'C' of deep democracy offer either somewhat underspecified or very strictly specified versions of the concept respectively. We saw in Chapter 6 that the 'B' calibration revealed inconsistencies in claims about necessity. Row 2 of Table 7.2 reports the minimal sufficient conditions under the 'B' calibration, and explains that the conjunction of mayoral support and citizen willingness to support contentious politics is entirely consistent with the sufficiency superset–subset relations across the cases. Even if neither condition is necessary or sufficient on its own, in the cases where they both occur in combination, that combination is sufficient to produce deepened democracy. Citizen contentious politics is highlighted in bold (Table 7.2) because it can be considered a core condition (Fiss, 2011). Mayoral support might be eliminated from this conjunction to form a more parsimonious solution if we were willing to make the counterfactual assumption that cases where mayoral support is absent but citizen willingness to support contentious politics is present would lead to deepened democracy. We do not have any empirical examples of those kinds of cases (row 4 of Tables 7.3 and 7.4) in this circumscribed dataset, and this appears a very difficult counterfactual assumption to accept based on theory. It might lead the researcher to search out such a case for their next research project.

[3] Note also that if I had ascribed all those cases the same scores in both mayoral support and deepened democracy at 0.49, the original result would also not change. What is at stake is a clear qualification rooted in qualitative evidence of when a condition is more absent or more present across cases.



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In the example it is crucial to note that the result is a function of the measurement calibrated to concepts we choose. We always make these implicit judgments when we infer. The method is used to make those judgements more explicit. If Wampler had observed using an ordinal scale that some of the cases were medium rather than merely low or high in terms of the observance of contentious politics, there might have been ground to calibrate degrees of membership differently and have a different result.

A critic might now observe that this only goes to show the perils of inferring with a small-N, using secondary data, but as I have previously argued, that criticism misunderstands the approach that rests on exploiting the advantages of intense engagement with conceptual clarity and casework itself. Transparency about what is at stake can be liberating rather than debilitating. At another extreme, with all this method and maths, should we now expect to have lost the sympathies of Sartori who would pour scorn on the over-conscious thinker 'who refuses to discuss heat unless he is given a thermometer' and is paralysed by 'logical perfectionism' (1970: 1033)? I hope not. Sartori famously champions the 'conscious thinker' who 'manages to say a great deal simply by saying hot and cold, warmer and cooler' (1970: 1033). I argue that despite the value of numerical reasoning to QCA, it is more a tool for the conscious than the unconscious thinker.

Another criticism could be that measures here for the outcome set are simplistic. The point I want to make, however, is that it may only be in the undertaking of this analysis that such decisions are highlighted. Rihoux and Lobe have shown that a stepwise QCA approach properly applied allows an iteration between maximal parsimony and complexity that arrives at a greater explanatory power (2009: 238). What this analysis of Wampler's typology shows is that applying QCA tools to existing research and its conclusions can highlight what is at stake in considering whether our summaries are overly complex or parsimonious.

## Expanded reproduction of Wampler's Brazil analysis

What of the sufficient conditions for deep democracy in the wider analysis of Wampler's five conditions? What combinations of conditions are consistently sufficient for deepened democracy in Brazil? The truth table based on the data in Chapter 6 is produced in Table 7.5. It contains a row representing each logical combination of presence (1) or absence (0) of a condition. Each possible row is identified by the number in the first column. With five conditions there are 32 logical



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**Table 7.5:** Truth table showing sufficient conditions for deepened democracy (5 conditions)

| Row | MS | CCP | PLE | REP | FBS | Out: DD | Incl. | PRI | Cases |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 31 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | Porto Alegre (i) |
| 32 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | ? | 0.936 | 0.853 | Porto Alegre (ii) |
| 14 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 1 | ? | 0.899 | 0.667 | Belo Horizonte |
| 29 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | ? | 0.815 | 0.5 | Recife, Santo André |
| 24 | 1 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | ? | 0.776 | 0.595 | Ipatinga |
| 9 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0.709 | 0 | São Paulo |
| 4 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0.378 | 0 | Blumenau |
| 2 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 0.338 | 0 | Rio Claro |

Note: MS is mayoral support; CCP is civil society using contentious and cooperative politics; PLE is positive legislative environment; FBS is financial basis for spending; REP is rules that encourage participation and DEEPD is deepened democracy. Incl. is the inclusion score and PRI refers to Proportional Reduction in Inconsistency.

combinations of presence or absence of each condition. In this table I have shortened the truth table to only display those eight rows that have empirical cases that are members (more in than out) of the row. A full table would include all the other 24 combinations – the 'logical remainders'. The row that cases are ascribed to is the combination of factors that best describes the case.[4] We then also get a value for how consistent the superset relationship is for the combination described in the row (the inclusion score). It is important to understand that the consistency score for each row includes all the cases, memberships in that row. The truth table does what it says on the tin and reveals some truths. It neatly summarizes concepts and measurements ascribed (calibrated) across all our cases.

What can we understand from this summary? The first thing to notice is there appears to be good variety across the cases as they fall into different rows, which reflects the rich information and diversity of cases Wampler studies in Brazil. Only two cases (Recife and Santo André in row 29) have the exact same combination of the five conditions. Even though they may display these conditions to varying degrees, their set memberships agree on being more in (or more out) of each

[4] With fuzzy sets, cases have partial membership in numerous rows but they will only have greater than 0.5 membership in one row. See footnote 1.



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influencing condition. Perhaps more interesting is that although they agree on all those inputs, the cases diverge on whether deep democracy occurs. Those cases even landed in different categories in Wampler's categorization described earlier. This could be an important finding. As before, we may want to investigate potential errors in coding or specification of the explanatory conditions we chose to include in the model. We should also think about whether the cases are more similar than expected. Recife had several changes to its mayor and the rules of PB over the time period. This might be evidence that it was worth considering splitting Recife into two cases covering separate time periods, as was done with Porto Alegre in these examples. Montambeault favours such a within-case comparison of Recife in her work separating the pre- and post-PT mayors (2016), which is a large influence on why I adopt the approach in my larger-N comparison. To solve that contradiction, we need to consider deepened democracy to have occurred in the 2000s but not in the pre-PT PB of the 1990s in Recife. Such a consideration would place the new 'Recife (ii)' case into a separate fully consistent row. We should be cautious, however, not to simply make the data fit our theories, and consider whether, in fact, these inconsistencies reveal a need to expand theories, but it would be a reasonable strategy here.

As we saw in the first analysis in the chapter, the second key step of the QCA following the identification of the truth table is to provide minimal Boolean expressions – parsimonious solution terms that explain the relationship among (combinations of) conditions and outcomes. This requires the analyst to decide on how much inconsistency in the sufficiency relation they are willing to accept to declare a combination of conditions (truth table row) sufficient to produce deepened democracy. Guidelines range anywhere upwards of 0.75. By accepting some inconsistency we are, in effect, modifying our claim to one that these conditions are 'almost always' sufficient for the outcome, which is good enough for most social scientists. I have placed a '?' in the outcome column for values in this range in Table 7.5. The transparency of the choice of consistency adds a very useful measure of fit to case-based inferences that can help colleagues evaluate the evidence base for empirical generalizations.

In Table 7.5 there is very little inconsistency in the first two rows. They differ only on whether the financial means to spend on PB projects was present or not in the case. For example, in Porto Alegre funds for PB and project implementation were not as plentiful in the early days in comparison, but the participatory budget still managed to deepen democracy, and by the mid-1990s the PT had



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reorganized finances such that they were in a quite healthy position. If we took a more conservative threshold of 0.9 (considering only cases with an inclusion score greater than that to be sufficient for the outcome), it would result in a solution term that immediately eliminated financial explanations as redundant. We would declare the presence of all other conditions in combination sufficient for the outcome:

S1) MS*CCP*PLE*REP → Deep democracy

Further minimization, making no concrete assumptions about the logical remainders[5] not shown in the table, can lead to a parsimonious expression suggesting the intersection of just two sets explaining deep democracy:

S2) CCP*REP → Deep democracy

In other words, we can make assumptions about cases for which we do not have data that would allow us to drop the mayoral support (ms) and positive legislative environment (ple) conditions from the solution formula – we do not know much about what happens when they are absent in the presence of the other conditions. But we already have data in the other rows that prevent us from considering citizen contentious politics (ccp) and rules encouraging participation (rep) irrelevant – we know better what happens when those conditions are absent in similar contexts. That is to say, the data provides evidential grounds that the combination of citizens' willingness to use both cooperative and contentious political action along with rules that enable participation is core[6] to any reasonable explanation of sufficient conditions for deep democracy. We might, however, need to be more or less cautious in theoretical assumptions about those rows for which we have less information. Concentrating focus on the eight rows of the truth table (Table 7.5) with strong empirical exemplars holds to the more conservative solution term containing more elements (see S1). Good

[5] These are the combinations for which there is no or low levels of empirical data. The algorithm will simply use any logical combination for which we have no cases to help eliminate conditions from the solution.

[6] On the idea of core conditions, see Ragin (2008); Fiss (2011); Misangyi et al (2017).



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knowledge of background theory and cases is, as always, paramount in general explanations that will include multiple assumptions.

There are three rows in Table 7.5, identified as 14, 29 and 24, that have inconsistencies within the range of 0.75–0.9. What should be thought of them? We can take them in turn. I think most analysts would include row 14 as sufficient for deep democracy. It has strong measures of fit and a strong case exemplar in Belo Horizonte. It is more difficult to make an argument for the other two. Row 29 as it appears currently contains a true logical contradiction – to include it as sufficient would be to ignore the absence of deepened democracy in the Santo André case. This row is as much an example of deep democracy as it is of not deep democracy, and therefore it is not that useful for explaining deep democracy. I would not consider there enough evidence to consider this combination sufficient. Finally, row 24 is worth considering. The inconsistent evidence for sufficiency here comes not from Ipatinga, which is the clearest example of this combination of conditions occurring in practice, but from the partial membership of two least successful cases of Blumenau and Rio Claro. The plot in Figure 7.1 visualizes the relationship between cases' memberships in row 24 and the outcome. The two cases lie below the diagonal, having greater membership in X than in Y.[7] In those cases, this combination of the presence of most influencing conditions, along with the absence of civil society use of cooperative and contentious politics, is at least perceptible to a minimal degree, whereas deepened democracy is not at all perceptible. This is the source of inconsistency. One reading of this data would argue that we should not draw inference about a combination of conditions from examples that are more or less 'irrelevant' because they are not strong examples of the combination of conditions, as opposed to truly deviant cases that would fall much further to the right of the X–Y plot in Figure 7.1 (see Schneider and Wagemann, 2012). On another reading this points to an advantage of fuzzy sets – the analysis shows that very minimal levels of the conditions that occurred strongly in Ipatinga are not associated with strong democratic outcomes – in fact, quite the opposite. The discussion highlights again that comparative analysis of this sort is about better learning the relationships between cases, data and theory.

[7] Note the logical property that more INUS conditions added to any conjunction will tend to increase consistency by lowering the value of case membership in a conjunction (lowering the value of X). The more we add caveats to a theory the more it ought to explain the cases (although perhaps not always for the better).



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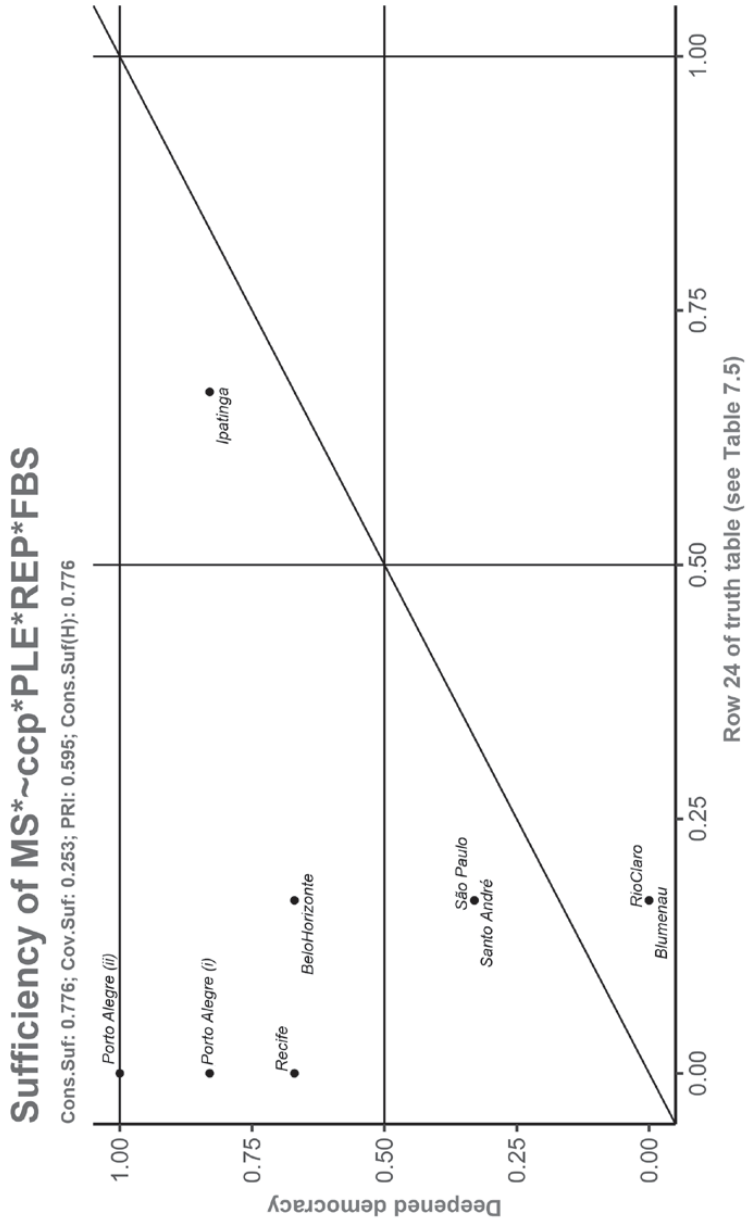
**Figure 7.1:** Sufficiency of row 24



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Even though the internal validity of the individual accounts of cases is sound, we might be conservative and wait for more information to be confident that the findings in Ipatinga and Recife generalize. QCA also provides good clues as to where we should go looking for new cases or further fieldwork (Schneider and Rohlfing, 2013). Table 7.6 reports the solution taking a consistency threshold of 0.89. Considering what we know about the cases, the strength of expectations and precision of the measurement from the material, including the top three rows as sufficient is, in my judgement, an appropriate interpretation. It means the most parsimonious solution retains only the conditions in bold in Table 7.6.[8]

The final analysis of Wampler's Brazilian data alone then presents the following model of necessary and sufficient conditions to explain deep democracy:

**CCP**⋆PLE⋆ MS⋆**REP** → Deepened democracy (I)

**CCP**⋆PLE⋆rep⋆**FBS** → Deepened democracy (II)

Alternatively, the model is factorized as:

**CCP**⋆PLE⋆[MS⋆**REP** + rep⋆**FBS**] → Deepened democracy

At an absolute minimum, the evidence suggests that in Brazil, use of contentious politics must be combined with either rules enabling participation or a financial basis for implementation of projects (core conditions in bold). Actually, the evidence suggests that municipalities in poor financial circumstances may need all the other conditions present in combination for deepened democracy. Alternatively, as in Belo Horizonte, even where rules chop and change and mayoral

[8] The specific parsimonious solution highlighted utilizes the row dominance argument. Otherwise four logically equivalent models are produced. This is an intermediate solution. The conservative solution would retain ~ms in the second term. However, I specify that no logical remainders include the absence of mayoral support as a sufficient condition for the outcome. The discussion of this condition and its high consistency with necessity provide extremely strong grounds for this theoretical expectation. In QCA the conservative solution allows no minimization using logical combinations of conditions for which we have no empirical assumptions (logical remainders). The parsimonious solution makes whatever assumptions lead to the most parsimonious solution. In the intermediate solution the researcher holds some theoretical expectations constant in the counterfactual analyses.



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**Table 7.6:** Truth table showing sufficient conditions for deepened democracy

| Expression | Inclusion | PRI | Coverage | Unique coverage | Cases |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| MS*__CCP__*PLE*__REP__ | 0.949 | 0.898 | 0.676 | 0.356 | Porto Alegre (i), Porto Alegre (ii) |
| __CCP__*PLE*~rep*__FBS__ | 0.915 | 0.746 | 0.393 | 0.073 | Belo Horizonte |
| Model | 0.954 | 0.915 | 0.749 | | |

Note: MS is mayoral support; CCP is citizens using contentious and cooperative politics; PLE is positive legislative environment; FBS is financial basis to spend; REP is rules encouraging participation. Bold = core condition.

support waxes and wanes, significant democratic empowerment comes when money is available, civil society demands responsive spending, and the legislative environment is not hostile to PB. This conclusion is not a million miles from Wampler's. It adds nuance. It is important to note that the absence of rules enabling participation is an INUS condition that cannot easily be removed from this explanation. This invites us to an interpretation that perhaps informality or updating of rules can be read in a positive light in certain circumstances. QCA requires a few machinations, for sure, but they are worth it if they give us extra accuracy in our empirical generalizations.

## Larger-N comparison of cases

The truth table for analysing the main dataset of 31 cases is presented again in Table 7.7. This resembles that previously presented in Table 7.1, but now includes measures of fit.

Again, the top two rows are highly consistent subsets of citizen control of PB (>0.97). Those constellations of conditions should be considered sufficient conditions for citizen control of PB decisions. It is worth noting that the small inconsistency in those cases, which is a minor contributor to inconsistency in each row that I discuss here, comes from the Cajamarca case. The case is worth highlighting because it represents one that has no extreme set membership values for its influencing conditions.[9] We might call it a middle-of-the-road

[9] Truth table rows were investigated using the pimplot command in the SetMethods package for R (Oana and Schneider, 2018).



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**Table 7.7:** Truth table for citizen control of PB for 31 cases

| # | PL | CSD | BSP | FBS | Outcome: CCPB | N | Incl | PRI | Cases |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 16 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 0.975 | 0.946 | João Monlevade, Porto Alegre |
| 15 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 1 | 2 | 0.971 | 0.913 | Cusco, Recife (ii) |
| 10 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 1 | ? | 3 | 0.904 | 0.701 | Montevideo, Poitou-Charentes, Sevilla |
| 12 | 1 | 0 | 1 | 1 | ? | 3 | 0.9 | 0.728 | Betim, Gravataí, Ipatinga |
| 11 | 1 | 0 | 1 | 0 | ? | 3 | 0.873 | 0.605 | Camaragibe, Lambayeque, Morsang-sur-Orge |
| 7 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 0.826 | 0.427 | Cajamarca |
| 14 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 1 | ? | 4 | 0.822 | 0.59 | Belo Horizonte, Chicago 49th Ward, Córdoba, New York |
| 3 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 0.8 | 0 | Buenos Aires |
| 9 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 0.797 | 0 | Berlin Lichtenberg |
| 13 | 1 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 3 | 0.791 | 0.431 | Moquegua, Rome, Santo André |
| 5 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 2 | 0.647 | 0.215 | Recife (i), São Paulo |
| 2 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 2 | 0.505 | 0 | Blumenau, Rio Claro |
| 1 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 0 | 4 | 0.501 | 0 | Ayacucho, Loreto, Mauá, Toronto |
| 4 | 0 | 0 | 1 | 1 | ? | 0 | – | – | |
| 6 | 0 | 1 | 0 | 1 | ? | 0 | – | – | |
| 8 | 0 | 1 | 1 | 1 | ? | 0 | – | – | |

Note: PL is participatory leadership; CSD is autonomous civil society demands; BSP is bureaucratic support; FBS is financial basis for spending; CCPB is citizen control of decisions in PB.

case. Its membership of the outcome is lower because it is described as having a number of less than satisfactory elements, and it appears that participants played a less influential role overall than elsewhere (see McNulty, 2011: 103). The one other case in the dataset that has a similar middle-of-the-road profile is Moquegua, McNulty's other moderate case. Cajamarca is, on my reading, of slightly more use in explaining the absence of citizen control of PB. It is a good example



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of a case whose evidence, although it contributes to some degree of deviance from the general relationship of sufficiency, is more easily overcome as one of more minor degrees of measurement rather than a difference of kind.

The variance in set scores and number of conditions means we can expect many rows to show some consistency with the outcome. The proportional reduction in inconsistency (PRI) measure can be used here to identify how much a combination of conditions is specifically a subset of the outcome vis-à-vis the absence of the outcome. We can discard all rows with <0.75 inclusion consistency and all those having low PRI scores <0.5 as insufficient for the outcome. This leaves four rows with more complex degrees of inconsistencies of evidence for consideration (10, 11, 12 and 14). These are indeed the four rows labelled as contradictions in Table 7.1. Each of these rows has some level of inconsistency but also contains at least one 'true logical contradiction'. That is to say, although the subset relationship of sufficiency holds up quite well across all cases (>0.82), in each row there is a deviant case contributing to inconsistency that is a good empirical example of that particular combinations of conditions.

These contradictions are not easy to resolve using any single method – for example, by adding another variable or by changing a set definition. If there were an easy way to do it, I would be presenting the resolution rather than the contradiction! However, these contradictions are usefully revealed by that data to raise important questions about causal theories in PB and point to areas where further research on PB may be most useful. The rows themselves offer options for good small-N research designs in order to try and better understand what explains opposing outcomes. But there is also an argument that they signify a slightly foggier portion of the research communities' PB map. Many of those rows differ from one another on single alternative conditions and exist in the same general area of the overall space of properties of participatory budgets. They agree on political leadership and vary a little on the combinations of other conditions. Therefore, blunt remedies such as recoding would simply push cases around the rows rather than solve contradictions. The five contradicting cases are Montevideo, Betim, Morsang-sur-Orge, Chicago and Córdoba. I duly considered coding errors, and returned again to the source material, but the calibration and evidence hold up quite well on reflection – in terms of outcomes, each of these cases disappointed in the long run where there tended to be evidence of growing co-optation or reduced implementation of programmes. The only borderline decision was to recode Morsang-sur-Orge's score on bureaucratic support,



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which would place it instead in the same row as Berlin-Lichtenberg. I decided to retain it as is, at it offers a more instructive presentation of the analytic process.

Another consideration would be to reintroduce an explanatory condition that distinguishes the contradictions from other cases. Something that captured the formality of rules might seem appropriate but in practice is not salutary. Formalizing new rules over time seemed to undermine successes in Montevideo, Chicago and Córdoba, but has been interpreted as helpful in places such as Belo Horizonte and Poitou-Charentes; it is therefore not clear that it is a condition that resolves the uncertainties. Until other evidence is brought forward to resolve the issue, our favoured general theories based on the evidence will depend on the levels of uncertainty we are willing to accept. Therefore, I produce the solutions that include or exclude these combinations of conditions as sufficient, and address the implications of each.

In this book I have argued that scholars of participatory democracy have erred perhaps too much on the side of constructing their outcomes of interest in more ideal and narrow terms. They are influenced by noble normative goals and want to set high standards. It is an easy position to defend in that sense. But it has significant drawbacks if it inadvertently lowers a fog over some avenues of empirical understanding. I, and I hope many other scholars, am willing to accept some contradictions and uncertainty where they are presented in a transparent manner. Including these four rows as sufficient yields the following minimal parsimonious solution for citizen control of PB.

**participatory leadership (PL)*bureaucratic support (BSP)** → citizen control (CCPB)

+ (OR)

**participatory leadership (PL)*financial basis for spending (FBS)** → citizen control (CCPB)

which can be factorized to:

**PL*(BSP + FBS)** → CCPB

This minimal solution lends further credence to the necessity of political leadership as it is INUS for all solutions. Participatory political leadership cannot be removed from any reasonable explanation of citizen control of the participatory programme based on the evidence.



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The overall model retains strong consistency and coverage for such a parsimonious one. Table 7.8 shows that the two alternate explanations of citizen control both uniquely account for some cases, but also account for a significant number of cases of PB.

We can reason that the empirical evidence reveals two broad types of successful PB. First, in row 1 of Table 7.8 participatory leadership combines with strong bureaucratic support for the programme. This solution uniquely explains Camaragibe and Lambayeque. In Lambayeque the officials were 'extremely flexible with the rules' to encourage broad participation (McNulty, 2011: 88). Camaragibe is a somewhat special case with an alternative form of 'participatory administration'. Participatory delegates elected for longer terms worked almost as an auxiliary phalanx of voluntary administrative staff, connecting the administration to the societies and neighbourhoods. The explanation also resonates in places like Gravataí, Cusco and Ipatinga, where a more top-down type of PB with strong administrative buy-in led to strong citizen influence on government even where it was a more managed process, sometimes when the funding environment is less forgiving.

**Table 7.8:** Sufficient conditions for citizen control across 31 cases

| # | Expression[1] | Inclusion | PRI | Cover-age | Unique coverage | Cases |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | PL*BSP | 0.898 | 0.834 | 0.686 | 0.191 | Camaragibe, Lambayeque, Morsang-sur-Orge, Betim, Gravataí, Ipatinga, Cusco, Recife (ii), João Monlevade, Porto Alegre |
| 2 | PL*FBS | 0.803 | 0.706 | 0.687 | 0.192 | Montevideo, Poitou-Charentes, Sevilla, Betim, Gravataí, Ipatinga, Belo Horizonte, Chicago 49th Ward, Córdoba, New York, João Monlevade, Porto Alegre |
| | Model | 0.813 | 0.728 | 0.878 | | |

[1] The expressions and solution are derived using the minimize command in the QCA package for R (Dusa, 2019) and esa command for truth table construction in setMethods (Oana and Schneider, 2018). All solution types are the same. PL is participatory leadership; BSP is bureaucratic support; FBS is financial basis for spending. PRI refers to Proportional Reduction in Inconsistency.



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Alternatively, bureaucratic activity is less relevant to successes in the second PB type. Here, what is needed to allow the participatory politicians to achieve their desired intentions is the relative absence of tight fiscal constraints. The combination uniquely explains New York and Belo Horizonte. It suggests some advantages for bigger cities and regional hubs. As in Porto Alegre, which is also a good example, even when faced with constraints on finances in the early days, administrations had more levers to pull to be able to build finances from different sources. Finance could also be a proxy for size in that size of city may allow some initial leeway in fiduciary support for the programme, allowing demonstration effects to occur and for the process to build over time.

## What has happened to civil society?

Although this neat parsimonious model seems the most appropriate one to derive from the data, it renders civil society irrelevant to explanations of citizen control of PB. As I said at the outset of the book, this is a controversial finding. In fact, anyone reading the early accounts of PB covered in Chapters 2 and 3 would find it alarming. If anything, in many of those accounts strong contentious civil society support for participation was valorized as the necessary condition above all others. There might be succour in the finding for those who believe in the possibility of governance-driven democratization and emancipatory outcomes where participation is initiated from the top down. Yet deviations from existing strongly held hypotheses always require a greater standard of evidence. Therefore, it is important to revisit the analysis. It is useful here to look again at the inconsistent truth table rows included in the solution.

If we look at rows 10, 11 and 12 in Table 7.7 together, these are all cases where committed participatory leaders operate in a context of either low, narrow or mollified civil society activity. Each row has one truly contradictory case, but pretty much all other evidence points to the rows' sufficiency for the outcome. The cases represent some mid-sized Brazilian cities, often commuter towns on the outskirts of a larger metropolis, as well as some of the more successful cases where PB has travelled and been adapted outside Brazil. Ignoring for the moment the three contradictory cases, all these cases have had some clear results in terms of providing empowerment to citizens. In general, however, they may be thought to represent a different kind of empowerment, which returns us to



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questions about the role civil society should play in democracy. The nature of the empowerment in these contradictory rows tends to be more top-down, aimed at building civil society capacity through the state. Either cases focus on specific policy areas where civil society is constrained, such as the Poitou-Charentes regional high school budget, or elsewhere, in municipalities with a weaker civil society where clientelism was normalized, civil society becomes mobilized in more positive ways, as in Gravataí and perhaps Ipatinga. These are examples of states trying to build civil society in a symbiotic relationship. The contradictory cases may then be understood as places where that gamble did not pay off. In Morsang-sur-Orge, Montevideo and Betim, it seems that for various reasons efforts to empower wider sections of the community hit stumbling blocks and fell flat.

What happens if we exclude all these types of cases and hold a higher consistency threshold of 0.95? We will now only include the first two rows in minimization and arrive at the following sufficient solution for citizen control:

**PL*CSD*BSP** → CCPB (Inclusion = 0.98, PRI = 0.96, Coverage = 0.539)

This solution suggests that financial constraints are, in fact, irrelevant to explanations of empowerment. Where all three actors – political leaders, bureaucrats and autonomous civil societies – are dedicated, and none is acting to veto or downgrade participation, we see good outcomes that sometimes overcome real financial constraints. Porto Alegre, Recife under the PT, Cusco and João Monlevade are the best examples of this explanation, but it is consistent across pretty much every case. The solution suggests that regardless of fiscal limits either due to constant bargaining with other tiers of government or a pressing need to firefight dire poverty, participatory democracy can still be successful when committed PB leaders work together with civil society and have bureaucratic support. The finding is important because it provides strong evidence to rebut claims that within successful cases the ability to spend freely is a necessary part of the explanation of good PB outcomes. The fear of a situation of scarce resources often leads to winding up of successful participatory practices. It can be surmised here that where finances were tight, participatory leaders, administrators and civil society were keenly aware of the need for coordinated action, and this was sufficient to allow the institutionalization of programmes with high levels of



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citizen control. There is almost no available evidence across all cases to reduce that explanation.

## Summary: successful conditions for citizen participation

In this chapter I have shown that the conditions we consider essential to explaining citizen control in PB depend on what standards of evidence we favour and, to some extent, on what conceptualization of PB success we hold to. Some things are clear. If participatory political leadership is a necessary condition for empowered participation, it is not, on its own, sufficient. Where we go from there depends on our attitude to risk and unexplained uncertainty.

The evidence suggests participatory entrepreneurs would do well to try to ensure bureaucrats can support or at best comply with and not have incentives to resist or derail participatory programmes. Combining bureaucratic buy-in for participatory programmes with political buy-in is a path to success in both more and less restrictive accounts. A less restrictive account suggests the combination alone is sufficient, but it is less restrictive because it fails to explain unsatisfactory outcomes in three cases where those conditions were present. Future studies might do well to revisit and compare the cases in those rows, or identify similar cases of participatory governance where those conditions occur with diverging outcomes to see if the contradictions can be explained through comparison between deviant and typical cases.

The most restrictive account requires that civil society remains autonomous, can engage in contentious politics, and continues to provide the countervailing power to state activity where needed. Those who prefer this account will have to be transparent that it is more restrictive, and such characteristics of civil society are less likely to occur in harmony with committed politicians and bureaucrats who are open to making use of invited and contested spaces. These instances where politicians, public servants and critical civil society actors are comfortable with one another are perhaps the real utopias, and therefore less likely to exist for many reasons, but we do have evidence for them here. Where they happen, it is almost impossible to dispute that democracy is significantly enhanced and policies and infrastructure projects proposed and chosen by ordinary citizens are implemented.

Nevertheless, a less restrictive answer to the question of what conditions are sufficient for success in citizen participation offers some uncertainty but more options. If we are willing to live with some unexplained inconsistency in our theories, we can also say that



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where bureaucratic support and civil society autonomy is lacking, participatory leaders who are able to leverage financial resources almost always produce significant gains in citizen empowerment.

These nuanced findings brought about by cumulation across cases provide a significant advance in our understanding of PB and participatory programmes. They have practical implications for those who wish to act to improve democracy. Implementers of participatory programmes should be aware that there is low risk of their programmes having insignificant effects on democracy where three conditions exist simultaneously to create a positive symbiosis – autonomous and active civil societies, committed politicians, and bureaucrats motivated to serve the public in innovative ways. However, I think democratic innovation scholars and practitioners of participation should also be aware that if they hold too tightly to these conditions, they are failing to explain numerous instances of democratic enhancement. There is plenty of useful evidence for action in between critiques of an 'anything goes' mentality and high standard bearing. Where some conditions seem out of reach because of the barriers in local contexts, as long as willing political leaders can be identified, support from either the bureaucracy or financial freedoms can suffice to produce citizen control of decisions.



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